

Tuesday, 7 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 31° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 17°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 16°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Buckingham Palace has confirmed that Prince Harry will not be staying at a royal residence during his next UK visit.

Royal sources indicate the Duke of Sussex missed the deadline to respond to an accommodation offer. This means he will need to make alternative arrangements for his stay.

ROYAL · UK
- 2

UK fighter jets have intercepted a Russian plane over the Norwegian Sea, with the Ministry of Defence calling the activity "unsafe" and "unprofessional".

This marks another incident involving Russian military aircraft operating near UK airspace. The MOD has stressed the importance of safe conduct in international skies.

DEFENCE · UK
- 3

Pizza Express reportedly launched an internal inquiry into Prince Andrew's alibi claim, after his assertion he was at their Woking branch.

BBC Newsnight has learned the pizza chain looked into the former Prince's statement. This follows his high-profile interview regarding his whereabouts on a particular date.

ROYAL · UK
- 4

Nigel Farage is facing questions after not declaring benefits from an ally, but says he's "done no wrongdoing."

The Liberal Democrats have called on the Reform UK leader to be transparent with the public. This comes amidst scrutiny over political funding and declarations.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

Two teenagers have been cleared of murdering a 15-year-old boy in a sword attack in Glasgow last year.

Amen Teklay died after a confrontation involving the two boys, then aged 14 and 15. The court heard details of the tragic incident that occurred in March 2025.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Taylor Swift has married Travis Kelce in a star-studded New York City ceremony, officiated by Adam Sandler!**

The celebration saw several Midtown Manhattan streets shut down as fans gathered. This follows months of speculation about the couple's plans.

ON AIR – What a wedding! Who do you think was on the guest list, and what sort of gifts do you think they received?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK
- 2 Sky is set to buy ITV's TV and streaming channels for up to £1.6bn, which could mean big changes for your favourite shows.**

The companies announced the deal on Monday, promising to keep ITV hits like I'm a Celebrity free to watch. It's a huge shake-up in the world of British broadcasting.

ON AIR – This is a massive deal in TV! What ITV shows do you hope stay exactly the same under Sky's ownership?

TV · THIS WEEK
- 3 The Specials' last ever album, taken from their 2019 performances at Coventry Cathedral, is set to be released this month.**

Fans are anticipating this album as a fitting tribute to the late Terry Hall. It captures the band's iconic sound from their historic shows.

ON AIR – The Specials' final album is coming! What's your favourite Specials track, and what memories does it bring back?

MUSIC · THIS MONTH
- 4 A reggae walk of fame has been launched in Harlesden, celebrating the area's rich reggae heritage and Windrush pioneers.**

The trail in north-west London honours the significant contributions of artists and figures to the genre. It's a wonderful way to mark their lasting legacy.

ON AIR – A fantastic new walk of fame for reggae! Which British reggae artists do you think deserve more recognition?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 5 More details are emerging about Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce's New York wedding, including a Dior dress and Adam Sandler's role.**

The couple tied the knot on Friday, with many celebrity guests in attendance. It sounds like quite the event, with plenty of talking points.

ON AIR – Adam Sandler officiating Taylor and Travis's wedding – what a choice! Who would be your dream celebrity to officiate your wedding?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **England have beaten Mexico 3-2 in an epic World Cup last-16 tie, with Jude Bellingham scoring twice and Harry Kane converting a penalty!**

The 10-man England side secured a dramatic victory in a hostile Mexico City. They now progress to a quarter-final meeting with Norway on Saturday.

ON AIR – What an incredible performance by 10-man England! Where does this win rank among England's greatest ever World Cup moments?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Erling Haaland has sent Norway into the World Cup quarter-finals for the first time, scoring twice as they beat Brazil 2-1!**

This stunning victory means Norway will now face England in the quarter-finals. Haaland's incredible form continues to make him the man to watch.

ON AIR – Haaland is on fire for Norway! Can anyone stop him and his team at this World Cup, or are they going all the way?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Tottenham have sealed a club-record £100m move for Newcastle's Sandro Tonali, in a massive transfer deal.**

The midfielder's move could reach a staggering £100m, making it one of the biggest transfers of the summer. Spurs fans will be eager to see him in action.

ON AIR – £100 million for Tonali! Is this a good deal for Tottenham, and what impact do you think he'll have on the team?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Italy's Jasmine Paolini has overcome a spirited challenge from Alexandra Eala to reach the Wimbledon quarter-finals.**

Paolini secured a gritty win, 6-4 4-6 6-3, ending the Filipina's historic run at the tournament. She's showing real determination on court.

ON AIR – Wimbledon is heating up! Who are you tipping to go all the way in the women's singles this year?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Jordan Henderson is expected to undergo surgery on the wrist injury he sustained while celebrating England's win over Mexico.**

The injury occurred during the jubilant scenes after England's dramatic World Cup victory. It's a frustrating blow for the midfielder.

ON AIR – Injuring yourself celebrating a goal – we've all done it! What's the most unusual injury you've ever picked up during a celebration?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The humble act of tidying up might be the secret to a happier outlook, according to new research.**
A study suggests that decluttering even a small area of your home can significantly reduce stress and boost feelings of well-being. It seems a clear space often leads to a clearer mind!
- 2 British bakers are bringing back the joy of traditional puddings, with classics like spotted dick and treacle sponge seeing a surge in popularity.**
Chefs and home cooks alike are rediscovering the comforting warmth of these beloved desserts, proving that sometimes, the old ways are the best ways.
- 3 A new trend sees people embracing the art of 'slow travel' to truly savour their holiday experiences.**
Instead of rushing from place to place, more holidaymakers are choosing to spend longer in one location, immersing themselves in local culture and enjoying a more relaxed pace.
- 4 The enduring appeal of 'vintage board games' is bringing families together for screen-free fun.**
Classics like Monopoly, Cluedo, and Scrabble are enjoying a renaissance as people seek nostalgic entertainment and quality time away from digital distractions.
- 5 Researchers have found that listening to the sounds of a crackling fire can actually have a calming effect on your heart rate.**
It seems our ancient connection to fire goes deeper than we thought, providing a comforting auditory backdrop that helps us relax and unwind.
- 6 The simple pleasure of 'baking your own bread' is becoming a widespread and satisfying hobby across the country.**
From sourdough to simple loaves, more people are discovering the therapeutic process and delicious results of creating their own fresh bread at home.
- 7 Gardening experts note a growing interest in cultivating 'edible flowers' to add flair to dishes.**
Beyond just looking pretty, flowers like pansies, nasturtiums, and borage are adding delicate flavours and vibrant colours to salads, desserts, and drinks.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with their shopping trolley when it gets a bit wonky, even if they know it doesn't really fix it?

ANSWER: ...GIVING IT A STERN SHAKE OR A LITTLE TAP, HOPING IT'LL MAGICALLY STRAIGHTEN UP!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'song' they absolutely have to sing along to, no matter where they are or who's listening?

ANSWER: ...WHEN THEIR FAVOURITE TUNE COMES ON, THEY JUST CAN'T HELP BUT BELT IT OUT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'new local walking path' you've never noticed before, and it feels like finding a hidden gem?

What's the best local discovery you've made right on your doorstep – perhaps a quiet park, a quirky shop, or a lovely walking route?

- We all have those 'childhood treats' that instantly transport us back in time with just one bite, don't we?

What's that one classic sweet or snack from your childhood that you still absolutely love to indulge in today?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Weather.** It actually rains diamonds on Saturn and Jupiter.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The sound of thunder is caused by clouds crashing into each other.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- Octopuses have three hearts.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.
- Hawaii is the only U.S. state that grows coffee.

On this day

Day 188 of the year, 177 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelburh of Faremoutiers; Christian feast day: Felix of Nantes; Christian feast day: Illidius; Christian feast day: Job of Manyava (Ukrainian Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1927 — Charlie Louvin, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1981 — Synyster Gates, American guitarist
- 1959 — Billy Campbell, American actor
- 1941 — Jim Rodford, English bass player (died 2018)
- 1997 — James Marriott, English musician and online content creator
- 1944 — Tony Jacklin, English golfer and sportscaster
- 1930 — Hank Mobley, American saxophonist and composer (died 1986)
- 1972 — Kirsten Vangsness, American actress and writer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2003 — NASA Opportunity rover, MER-B or Mars Exploration Rover-B, was launched into space aboard a Delta II rocket.
- 1997 — The Turkish Armed Forces withdraw from northern Iraq after assisting the Kurdistan Democratic Party in the Iraqi Kurdish Civil War.
- 2017 — The Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons was adopted with 122 countries voting in favour.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The ocean liner SS United States passes Bishop Rock on her maiden voyage, breaking the transatlantic speed record to become the fastest passenger ship in the world.
- 1980 — During the Lebanese Civil War, 83 Tiger militants are killed during what will be known as the Safra massacre.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1959 — Venus occults the star Regulus. This rare event is used to determine the diameter of Venus and the structure of the Venusian atmosphere.
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1991 — Yugoslav Wars: The Brioni Agreement ends the ten-day independence war in Slovenia against the rest of the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.

- 2017 — The Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons was adopted with 122 countries voting in favour.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 189 of the year, 176 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abda and Sabas; Christian Feast Day: Auspicius of Trier; Christian Feast Day: Grimbald; Christian Feast Day: Landrada. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Pauline Quirke, English actress
- 1970 — Beck, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1963 — Mark Christopher, American director and screenwriter
- 1940 — Joe B. Mauldin, American bass player and songwriter (died 2015)
- 1961 — Andrew Fletcher, English keyboard player (died 2022)
- 1998 — Jaden Smith, American actor and rapper
- 1944 — Jaimoe, American drummer
- 1952 — Larry Garner, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — King Mwambutsa IV Bangiriceng of Burundi is deposed by his son Prince Charles Ndizi.
- 2022 — Former Japanese prime minister Shinzo Abe is shot and killed with an improvised firearm due to resentment against the Unification Church.
- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1970 — Richard Nixon delivers a special congressional message enunciating Native American self-determination as official US Indian policy, leading to the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act of 1975.
- 1982 — A failed assassination attempt against Iraqi president Saddam Hussein results in the Dujail Massacre over the next several months.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)